

by John Kestner, who works at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) Media Lab in the US.

Firefox 4 Beta 3 for mobiles

Mozilla has released the beta version of its mobile browser—Firefox 4 Beta 3. The mobile browser is available to Android and Maemo platforms and can be directly downloaded from the microsite or from the Android Market.

Firefox for mobile was originally launched as Fennec. The new release comes with many added features. The best amongst them are copy-paste tools for the browser's URL bar, integration of Firefox Sync, easier add-ons discovery, and option to save webpages as PDFs. Firefox Sync will allow users to sync their browsing data between different devices. The Save as PDF option allows you to save webpages and view them later without going online.

Now a 3D website

Stereografix, a UK-based company, has launched a stereoscopic 3D website which is designed specifically for viewing on 3D HD TV sets. Though the website is still a prototype, basic requirements to correctly view it in 3D are a computer or laptop connected to a 3D television, a compatible browser and 3D viewing glasses.

The website, stereoscopic-3d.co.uk, features a 3D interface as well as additional content. It has two optimised display versions: active (LCD shuttering) and passive (polarised). Although you need 3D glasses to view the site now, the company is working toward a version with passive 3D televisions.

Access online accounts using your fingertip

It's really tough to remember all your user names and passwords for multiple online accounts. Sara Alotaibi from Southampton University has a solution that allows you to access all your security codes with your fingertip. The system, called FingerID, makes use

of fingerprint technology to enter the correct password on its own for any website that you may visit.

Once registered, you have to submit all your existing user names and passwords for each of your online accounts followed by scanning of your finger. This gives you access to all your accounts online by swiping your fingertip. The system can protect the users from online fraud and identity theft.

World's fastest DX11 GPU

NVIDIA has announced a consumer GPU based on its Fermi architecture. The new GPU has been re-engineered from the transistor-level up to deliver increased power efficiency and performance over previous-generation products.

The GeForce GTX 580 is claimed to deliver the world's fastest performance for DirectX11 (DX11) games, and support for NVIDIA 3D Vision, Surround, PhysX, SLI and CUDA technologies. The combination of an innovative vapour-chamber thermal solution and new architectural enhancements is said to make the fastest and quietest GPU in its class, delivering an increase of up to 35 per cent in performance per watt, and performance that is up to 30 per cent faster than the original GeForce GTX 480.

For the most recent games that feature tessellation—key feature of DX11—the 512-core GeForce GTX 580 is up to 160 per cent faster than counterparts. Even in previous-generation DX9 and DX10 games, it is faster by up to 62 per cent.

Industry's first light optical sensor

Vishay Intertechnology claims its new proximity and ambient-light optical sensor to be the industry's first to combine an IR emitter, PIN photodiode, ambient light detector, signal processing IC and a 16-bit analogue-to-digital converter (ADC) in one small 3.95×3.95×0.75mm³ leadless, surface-mount package.

The space-saving VCNL4000 supports an easy-to-use I²C bus communication interface and greatly simplifies designs in a variety of consumer and industrial applications.

For mobile devices such as smartphones, touch phones, PDAs, GPS units and digital cameras, in addition to computing and industrial devices and displays, the VCNL4000 saves power as a proximity sensor for touch-screen locking, and serves as an integrated ambient light function for display/keyboard contrast control and dimming. Containing all the circuitry needed for these applications in one device, it eliminates the need for light barriers and optical alignment of the IR emitter and photodiode.

Highest-performance green desktop hard drive

Seagate claims its Barracuda Green hard drive to be the industry's highest-performance, eco-friendly 8.9cm (3.5-inch) desktop drive for low-power personal computers, multi-drive home networking systems and external PC storage.

The Barracuda Green hard drive, formerly Barracuda LP, combines the



GeForce GTX 580 GPU